

1. Initiative Definition

1a. Overview

Construction Payroll Setup Guided Experience is a streamlined, embedded onboarding wizard designed to help small construction contractors (1–10 employees) configure payroll within the Trimble Financials accounting solution. It targets non-expert users by abstracting complex regulatory requirements into a plain-language, linear workflow. This initiative focuses on reducing the "Compliance Cliff" anxiety by delivering a "safety net" experience for basic payroll needs (non-union, simple tax jurisdictions).

1b. Problem Statement

Core Problem: Small construction business owners ("Accidental Administrators") suffer from "Regulatory Paralysis." They fear the existential financial risks of payroll errors (IRS penalties, debarment) but find generic tools too broad and specialized construction ERPs too complex/expensive.

Impact: This anxiety drives them to inefficient manual workarounds (Excel) or expensive outsourcing, preventing them from bidding on profitable work or scaling.

Why current tools fail: Generic tools lack construction logic (job costing integration), while legacy tools require deep domain expertise to configure.

1c. Goals

- **Eliminate Setup Anxiety:** Provide a "safety net" experience that guides users through compliance without requiring payroll expertise.
- **Accelerate Time-to-Value:** Drastically reduce the time from purchase to "First Payroll Run."
- **Ensure Data Integrity:** Guarantee accurate GL integration and tax configuration from Day 1 to prevent downstream accounting errors.

1d. Success Metrics aligned to goals

Metric	Target	Type
Setup Completion Rate	>80% of eligible users complete wizard w/o support	User / Usability

Time-to-First-Run	10x reduction (compared to legacy manual setup)	Efficiency
Tax Configuration Errors	0% related to state jurisdiction config	Quality / Compliance
Support Volume	<5% of new signups contact support during setup	Inferred

1e. Out of Scope

- Union / Collective Bargaining Agreements (CBAs) configuration.
- Certified Payroll / Prevailing Wage reporting setup.
- Multi-state employees (living/working in different states).
- **Crucial Constraint:** States with State Income Tax (MVP is restricted to simplified tax jurisdictions, e.g., TX, TN, FL, etc.).

2. Users & Usage Context

2a. Personas

Name/Role	Description	Goals	Pain Points
The Owner-Operator	Hands-on contractor, hates paperwork.	"Set it and forget it." Wants to pay crews and get back to the job site.	Fear of IRS; overwhelmed by forms/codes; hates administrative friction.
The Office Manager	Spouse/Partner or part-time admin.	Accuracy and GL integrity. Wants "one envelope" for all financial data.	"Chain of custody" errors (manual data entry); fragmented systems; anxiety about missing deadlines.

2b. User Journeys / Workflows

Entry: User clicks "Payroll" tab in Accounting App.

1. **Welcome:** "Get Started" splash screen setting expectations.
 2. **Company Profile:** Confirm sourced details (Name, Address, Type).
 3. **Payroll Contact:** Define signatory/admin.
 4. **Pay Schedule:** Define frequency/dates.
 5. **Bank Account:** Link account for funding.
 6. **Tax Setup (Federal):** Confirm EIN.
 7. **Tax Setup (State/Local):** Address-based detection. **System Guardrail:** If address is in out-of-scope state (e.g., CA), divert to waitlist/support.
 8. **E-File/Pay:** Authorization for electronic handling.
 9. **Workers Comp:** Policy entry.
- Exit:** Dashboard (Ready to Run Payroll).

2c. High-Level Use Cases

Use Case	Description	Priority
UC-1: Basic Entity Setup	User confirms business identity and structure synced from the accounting core.	PO
UC-2: Schedule Configuration	User defines pay frequency (Weekly/Bi-Weekly) to establish the payroll calendar.	PO
UC-3: Bank Connection	User securely links a bank account for tax withdrawals and net pay funding.	PO
UC-4: Tax Jurisdiction Guardrail	System detects user location; allows setup for simple states, blocks/warns for complex states (Income Tax/Union).	PO

UC-5: Regulatory Authorization	User digitally signs forms (e.g., 8655) to authorize e-filing/e-payment.	PO
--------------------------------	--	----

3. Requirements w/ supporting material

3a. Functional Requirements

Onboarding & Company Profile

- **FR-1.1:** The system shall display a "Welcome" wizard explaining required documents (EIN, Bank credentials) before starting.
- **FR-1.2:** The system shall pre-fill Company Profile data (Legal Name, Address, Entity Type) from the core Trimble Financials solution to minimize entry.
- **FR-1.3:** The system shall validate the "Primary Payroll Contact" (Signatory) details.

Scheduling & Banking

- **FR-2.1:** The system shall allow selection of Pay Schedule (Weekly, Bi-Weekly, Semi-Monthly, Monthly) and calculate the first pay date automatically based on selection.
- **FR-2.2:** The system shall integrate with a banking provider (e.g., Plaid/Stripe—**[TBD]**) to verify account ownership instantly.
- **FR-2.3:** The system shall require designation of a single funding account for both Net Pay and Taxes.

Tax & Compliance (The "Safety Net")

- **FR-3.1:** The system shall validate the Federal EIN format.
- **FR-3.2:** The system shall automatically determine State and Local tax requirements based on the Company Address.
- **FR-3.3 (Guardrail):** The system shall **block or redirect** users if their address is in a state with State Income Tax or complex local taxes not supported in MVP.
- **FR-3.4:** The system shall allow users to input State Unemployment Insurance (SUI) rates.

E-Services & Legal

- **FR-4.1:** The system shall present E-File/E-Pay authorization forms for digital signature.
- **FR-4.2:** The system shall capture Workers' Compensation policy details (Carrier, Policy #, Rate Class) to support future job costing reports.

3b. Non-Functional Requirements

- **Security:** All PII (Tax IDs, Bank Accts) must be encrypted at rest and in transit (AES-256).

PII must be obfuscated in the UI.

- **Usability:** The wizard must support "Save and Exit" to allow users to gather missing info and return.
- **Accuracy:** GL mapping must occur automatically in the background (Complexity Abstraction) without user configuration.

3c. Technical Dependencies (High-Level Only)

Data Requirements

- **Key Entities:** Company, BankAccount, TaxJurisdiction, PaySchedule, Signatory.
- **Validation:** Address validation (USPS standard) is critical for accurate Tax Jurisdiction detection.

Integration Requirements

- **Core Accounting (Prism):** Read/Write access to Company Profile and General Ledger (for mapping default accounts).
- **Banking Provider:** API for instant account verification (IAV).
- **Tax Engine (Internal/External [TBD]):** To validate jurisdiction rules based on address.

3d. Epics (Non-Exhaustive)

Epic	Description	Goals Supported	Related Use Cases
E-1: Wizard Framework	The "shell" of the onboarding experience, including navigation, progress tracking, and state management (Save/Resume).	Eliminate Anxiety	All
E-2: Company & Profile Sync	Integration with Core Financials to pull legal entity data and push back payroll configuration	Time-to-Value	UC-1

	status.		
E-3: Banking & Funding	Secure connection of funding source and verification of ownership.	Data Integrity	UC-3
E-4: Tax Logic & Guardrails	The rules engine that determines if a user is eligible (MVP states) and configures tax settings accordingly.	Eliminate Anxiety	UC-4
E-5: E-Sign & Authorization	Digital capture of legal signatures for tax filing authorization.	Time-to-Value	UC-5

3e. High-level acceptance criteria

- **Workflow:** A user can navigate from "Welcome" to "Dashboard" linearly without encountering technical error messages.
- **Data Sync:** Updating the Company Address in the Wizard updates the Tax Jurisdiction logic immediately.
- **Guardrails:** A user entering a California address (complex state) receives a "Not Supported Yet" message and cannot proceed to Tax Setup.
- **Banking:** Bank account is verified via micro-deposit or instant login before payroll can be run.
- **Readiness:** The "Run Payroll" button is disabled until all wizard steps are marked "Complete."

3f. Links to prototypes

- **Prototype Flow:** [PR Comp OB Proto.png](#) (Refer to file for UI flow and step sequence).
-

4. Delivery Plan

4a. Release Plan / Phasing

- **MVP (Mid-Q4):**
 - Scope: 1-10 employees, No State Income Tax states (e.g., TX, FL, TN, WA, NV, SD, WY), Non-Union, Non-Certified.
 - Goal: Prove the "Guided Experience" reduces support volume.
 - **Phase 2 (Fast Follow):**
 - Scope: Add State Income Tax support for high-volume states (e.g., NC, GA, AZ).
 - **Phase 3 (Growth - Inferred from MRD):**
 - Scope: Certified Payroll (WH-347) setup and Multi-state reciprocity rules.
-

5. Supporting Information

5a. Assumptions

- Users have a valid EIN and Business Bank Account prior to starting.
- The Core Accounting system has a functional GL to map to.
- Users in the MVP cohort are Single-State operators.

5b. Dependencies

- **Trimble Financials Core Team:** For GL API access and Company Profile sync.
- **Legal/Compliance Team:** To validate the text of the E-File authorization forms.

5c. Risks & Mitigations

Risk	Probability	Impact	Mitigation
User Drop-off	Medium	High	Implement "Save & Resume" and proactive email reminders.
Regulatory Change	Medium	High	 Human Review: Ensure tax engine is updated via API or external partner (e.g., Atrix/ADP) rather than hardcoded.

Ineligible Users	High	Medium	rigorous address validation at Step 2 to "fail fast" and redirect complex users (CA, NY) to support/sales.
------------------	------	--------	--

5d. Links to Analytics & Telemetry

- **Funnel Tracking:** Track drop-off rate at each step of the wizard (Company -> Bank -> Tax).
- **Time-on-Task:** Measure duration of the "Tax Setup" step specifically.

5e. Open Questions

- **[TBD]** Which specific banking partner are we using for IAV (Plaid, Stripe, etc.)?
- **[TBD]** Are we building the tax logic engine natively or integrating a "headless" provider (e.g., Check, Gusto Embedded) for the tax calculations? (Stakeholder interviews suggest "Buy/Partner" for tax engine).